Dashboard Design & Predictive Forecasting Guide

VAR Model · Daily Conversions · Lead Source Analysis

VAR Forecasting | Zoho Analytics | Lead Sources | Conversion Analysis | Trend Lines

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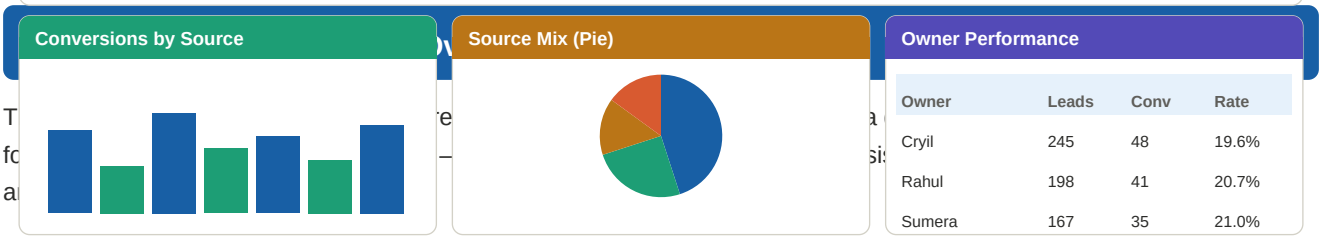


Dashboard mockup showing all 4 rows: KPI tiles, main forecast chart, source charts, and owner table

Row	Widget Type	Purpose	Priority
Row 1	KPI Tiles (×4)	At-a-glance summary numbers	Critical
Row 2	Area Chart + Forecast	Daily trend + VAR prediction	Critical
Row 3a	Horizontal Bar	Volume by lead source	High
Row 3b	Pie / Donut	Source mix as % of total	Medium
Row 3c	Summary Table	Owner performance ranking	High
Row 4	Day-of-Week Bar	Which days convert best	Medium

02 Section 2 — KPI Tiles

72,450	18,320	25.3%	72
Total Leads (All Time)	Total Conversions	Conversion Rate	Avg Conversions / Day

KPI Tile	Zoho Formula	Insight It Gives
Total Leads	COUNT(Id)	Overall pipeline size
Daily Conversions	SUM(daily_conversions)	How many convert each day
Conversion Rate %	SUM(conversions)/COUNT(leads)*100	Efficiency of your funnel
Avg Conversions/Day	SUM(conversions)/COUNT(DISTINCT date)	Baseline daily target
Top Source Today	MAX by source group	Which channel is winning today
Deposit Revenue	SUM(Deposite Amount)	Revenue from converted leads

How to create KPI tiles in Zoho Analytics:

1. New Widget → KPI Widget
2. Select your query table (daily_source_summary)
3. Choose aggregate: SUM for conversions, COUNT for leads
4. Set comparison period: vs. previous 30 days
5. Enable trend arrow (up/down indicator)

03 Section 3 — Main Forecast Chart (VAR Model)

The main chart is an Area Chart of daily_conversions with the VAR forecast overlay. VAR (Vector AutoRegression) uses your top 5 lead sources as influencing factors to produce a multivariate forecast that accounts for how each source drives conversions.

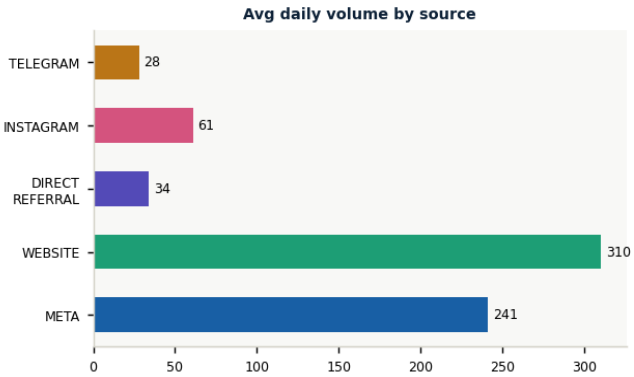
Setting	Value	Why
Model	VAR	Multivariate — uses lead sources as predictors
Influencing Factors	5 selected	META, WEBSITE, DIRECT, INSTAGRAM, TELEGRAM
AutoRegressive p	3	Looks back 3 days — stable, avoids overfitting
Forecast Length	30 days	One month forward visibility
Ignore Last	7 days	Excludes recent anomalies from model training
Confidence %	90%	Tight enough to be actionable for daily data
Display Negative as 0	Checked	Conversions cannot be negative

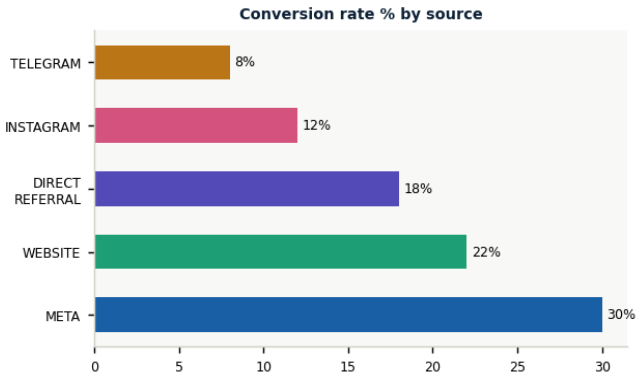
Recommended chart settings in Zoho Analytics:

- Chart type: Area Chart (fills under the curve — easier to read than line)
- X-axis: lead_date grouped by Day
- Y-axis: SUM(daily_conversions)
- Color: Blue (#378ADD) for actual, Dark blue (#0D2137) for forecast dashes
- X-axis label interval: Weekly (avoids date crowding)
- Enable smooth curve if available

04 Section 4 — Lead Source Analysis Charts

These charts reveal which channels bring the most leads and which convert best. Volume and conversion rate together determine which sources deserve more investment.

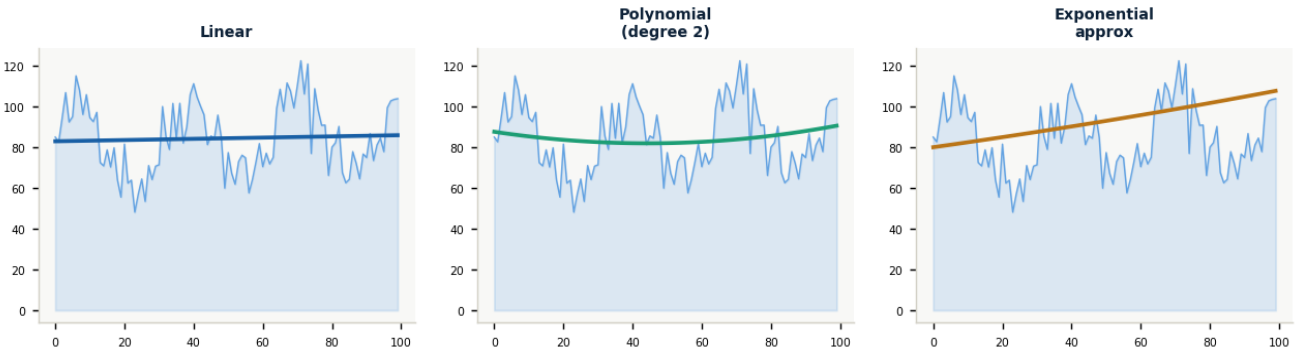




Left: average daily lead volume per source | Right: conversion rate % per source

Rank	Source	Avg Daily Vol	Conv Rate	VAR Factor?
#1	META_ALL	241	~30%	Yes
#2	WEBSITE_ALL	310	~22%	Yes
#3	DIRECT_REFERRAL	34	~18%	Yes
#4	INSTAGRAM_ALL	61	~12%	Yes
#5	TELEGRAM_ALL	28	~8%	Yes
—	SMS_ALL	~0	0%	No — zero variance
—	RCS_ALL	~0	0%	No — zero variance

05 Section 5 — Trend Line Types



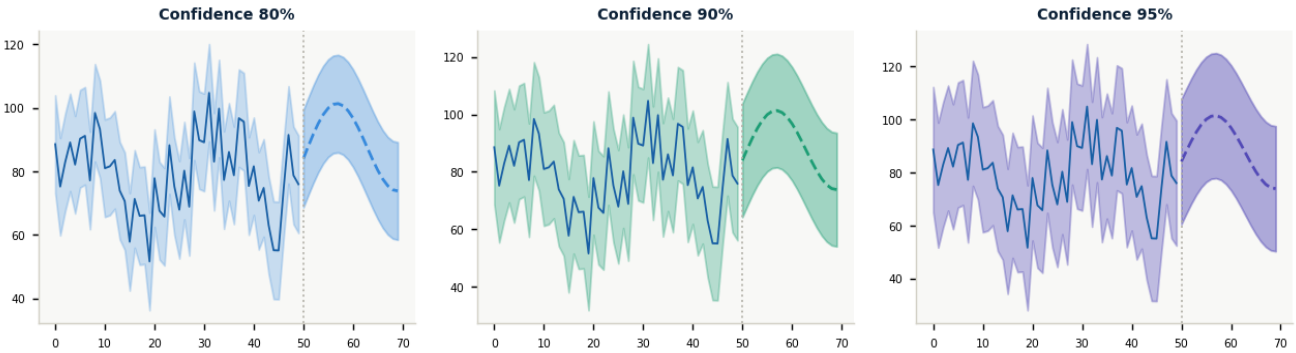
Comparison of linear, polynomial (degree 2) and exponential trend lines on sample conversion data

Trend Line	Formula	Best For Your Data	Recommendation
Auto	Zoho selects best fit	Quick starting point	Use first
Linear	y = mx + b	Stable long-term direction	Use for overview
Logarithmic	y = a·ln(x) + b	Fast early growth then flattening	Good for META peak
Exponential	y = a·e^(bx)	Accelerating growth/decay	Avoid — unstable
Power	y = a·x^b	Proportional scaling	Optional
Polynomial deg 2	y = ax2 + bx + c	Peak-decline-stabilise pattern	Best choice
Polynomial deg 3	y = ax3 + bx2 + cx + d	Multiple peaks and troughs	Use carefully
Polynomial deg 4+	Complex curve	Over-engineering daily noisy data	Avoid

Recommended sequence: Start with Auto → try Polynomial degree 2 → compare with Linear. Your data shows a peak in mid-2024 followed by stabilisation — this is a classic degree-2 polynomial shape.

06 Section 6 — Confidence Bands

The confidence band is the shaded area around your forecast line. It shows the range within which actual conversions are expected to fall. Wider bands = more uncertainty. Narrower bands = more precision but higher risk of being wrong.



80% vs 90% vs 95% confidence bands on the same conversion forecast — notice band width difference

Confidence %	Band Width	Use When	For Your Data
80%	Narrowest	Internal daily tracking	Too tight — daily data is noisy
90%	Moderate	Operational daily decisions	Recommended for your use case
95%	Wide	Monthly business reviews	Use for management reporting
99%	Widest	High-stakes investment decisions	Bands too wide to be actionable

Calibration check: After 30 days, count how many actual daily values fell inside your confidence band. For 90% confidence, at least 27 out of 30 days should be inside. If fewer than that, increase to 95%.

07 Section 7 — Additional Analysis Types

Beyond the core forecast, these additional analyses can be built inside Zoho Analytics to provide deeper business insights from your CRM data.

Day-of-Week Analysis	Bar chart: average conversions by day of week (Mon-Sun). Reveals which days your team converts best. Helps with staffing and call scheduling decisions.	*Zoho SQL hint:* `GROUP BY DAYOFWEEK(lead_date)`
Monthly Cohort Trend	Line chart: monthly total conversions Jan 2023 to today. Shows long-term business growth trajectory. Use Polynomial degree 2 trend line to see the peak-decline pattern clearly.	*Zoho SQL hint:* `GROUP BY YEAR, MONTH`
Conversion Rate by Source	Horizontal bar: conversions/total_leads % for each source. Answers "which source has the best quality leads?" META at 30% vs TELEGRAM at 8% — massive difference in lead quality.	*Zoho SQL hint:* `SUM(conversions)/COUNT(leads)*100 per source`
Owner Performance Heatmap	Table or heatmap: each owner vs day of week showing conversion rate. Identifies which owners perform better on which days. Supports training and scheduling.	*Zoho SQL hint:* `GROUP BY owner, DAYOFWEEK`
Lead-to-Conversion Time Analysis	Histogram: days between Created Time and Converted Date Time. Shows how long it typically takes to convert a lead. Helps set realistic follow-up SLAs.	*Zoho SQL hint:* `DATEDIFF(Converted_Date_Time, Created_Time)`
Anomaly Detection	Add reference lines on your main chart marking dates with unusual spikes or drops. The April 2024 spike (335 conversions) should be flagged and investigated — it distorts forecasts.	*Zoho SQL hint:* `Manually via reference line in chart settings`
Deposit Revenue Forecast	Separate forecast chart for SUM(Deposite Amount) by day. Predicts daily revenue from conversions — more valuable for business planning than just counting leads.	*Zoho SQL hint:* `SUM("Deposite Amount") WHERE Is_Converted = Yes`
Source Shift Analysis	Stacked area chart showing how the mix of META vs WEBSITE vs others has changed month by month. Your data shows a clear shift from META dominance in 2024 to WEBSITE taking over in 2025-26.	*Zoho SQL hint:* `Monthly source volumes stacked`

08 Section 8 — Step-by-Step Setup in Zoho Analytics

Step 01: Connect Zoho CRM to Zoho Analytics

- Go to Zoho Analytics → New Workspace
- Select "Import from Zoho CRM"
- Choose the Leads/Followup module
- Set sync range to "All Data" — not just last 30 days
- Enable auto-sync every 3 hours

Step 02: Create the Query Table

- New → Query Table
- Paste the consolidated SQL (with META_ALL, WEBSITE_ALL etc.)
- Add WHERE DATE > 2024-05-01 filter
- Name it: daily_source_summary
- Save and verify row count (~700+ rows)

Step 03: Build the Main Forecast Chart

- New Chart → Area Chart
- X-axis: lead_date | Y-axis: SUM(daily_conversions)
- Click Forecast → VAR model
- Set 5 influencing factors: META, WEBSITE, DIRECT, INSTAGRAM, TELEGRAM
- AutoRegressive p=3 | Length=30 days | Ignore Last=7 | Confidence=90%

Step 04: Add Trend Line

- Edit the same chart → Add Trend Line
- Start with Auto — note which model Zoho selects
- Switch to Polynomial degree 2 for comparison
- Keep whichever fits the historical shape better
- Do NOT use degree 4+ on daily data

Step 05: Build Supporting Charts

- Source volume bar chart: GROUP BY source, SUM leads
- Conversion rate bar chart: SUM(conversions)/SUM(leads)*100
- Day-of-week bar chart: GROUP BY DAYOFWEEK(lead_date)
- Owner table: GROUP BY Followup Owner Name
- Monthly cohort line: GROUP BY YEAR, MONTH

Step 06: Assemble the Dashboard

- New Dashboard → drag and drop all charts
- Row 1: 4 KPI tiles across full width
- Row 2: Main forecast chart (full width)
- Row 3: Source bar | Pie chart | Owner table (3 columns)
- Row 4: Day-of-week bar | Monthly trend (2 columns)
- Add date range filter widget at the top

09 Section 9 — SQL Queries Reference

Main Forecast Query

```
SELECT DATE("Created Time") AS lead_date, COUNT(*) AS total_leads, SUM(CASE WHEN "Is Converted"='Yes' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS daily_conversions, SUM(CASE WHEN UPPER("Lead Source_1") LIKE '%META%' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS META_ALL, SUM(CASE WHEN UPPER("Lead Source_1") LIKE '%MAIN%WEBSITE%' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS WEBSITE_ALL, SUM(CASE WHEN UPPER("Lead Source_1") LIKE '%DIRECT%' OR UPPER("Lead Source_1") LIKE '%REFERRAL%' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS DIRECT_REFERRAL, SUM(CASE WHEN UPPER("Lead Source_1") LIKE '%INSTAGRAM%' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS INSTAGRAM_ALL, SUM(CASE WHEN UPPER("Lead Source_1") LIKE '%TELEGRAM%' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS TELEGRAM_ALL FROM "Followup" WHERE DATE("Created Time") > '2024-05-01' GROUP BY DATE("Created Time") ORDER BY lead_date
```

Date Range Check

```
SELECT MIN(DATE("Created Time")) AS earliest_date, MAX(DATE("Created Time")) AS latest_date, COUNT(DISTINCT DATE("Created Time")) AS total_days, COUNT(*) AS total_records FROM "Followup"
```

Owner Performance

```
SELECT "Followup Owner Name" AS owner, COUNT(*) AS total_leads, SUM(CASE WHEN "Is Converted"='Yes' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS conversions, ROUND(SUM(CASE WHEN "Is Converted"='Yes' THEN 1 ELSE 0 END)*100.0/COUNT(*),2) AS conv_rate_pct FROM "Followup" GROUP BY "Followup Owner Name" ORDER BY conv_rate_pct DESC
```